Information Technology Acceptable Use

POLICY #IT23-008.2

Purpose

This policy establishes specific requirements for use of computing, information, and network resources owned by the Iowa Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) and utilized by all users. This document sets forth the direction necessary for users to ensure the information and data they create, process, store, or transmit on Iowa HHS-owned resources remains protected and confidential. Additionally, any activities users engage in while using Iowa HHS-owned devices falls within the parameters of state and federal law, as well as adhering to all additional practices, restrictions, and requirements as defined within this policy. Employees must comply with State of Iowa security procedures, and ensure adequate security measures are in place to protect the equipment and information housed or stored on assigned computers. Failure to comply with security procedures and regulations may result in revocation of the staff person's telework agreement or be grounds for disciplinary action.

Scope and Coordination

This policy and procedure apply to all users of Iowa HHS computing, information, and network resources which refers to all state employees, contractors, interns, volunteers, and approved federal reviewers. This information has been developed in coordination with internal staff that access Iowa HHS information systems who are subject to follow these requirements.

Roles and Responsibilities

1. Department of Management, Regulatory and Security Office (REGSEC):
    a. Review and update the content of this policy annually or when changes occur.
2. Department of Management, Enterprise Infrastructure Services (BEIS):
    a. Provide the technology and equipment necessary to telework and complete assigned job duties in a secure manner consistent with this policy.
3. Supervisors:
    a. Make reasonable efforts to monitor their team members' use of HHS-issued accounts and devices to ensure all users follow HHS policies.
4. Users:
    a. Follow the requirements in this policy as well as other policies related to the acceptable use of HHS-owned assets, information, and data.
    b. Exercise good judgment regarding the appropriate use of information, computing devices, and network resources by following all applicable policies, standards, and state and federal laws and regulations.

Definitions

1. Confidential: Preserving authorized restrictions on information access and disclosure including means for protecting personal privacy and proprietary information. (NIST 800-53 Rev 5)
2. Incident: A security incident is any event that poses a threat to HHS security with respect to confidentiality, integrity, and availability of HHS information. All security breaches are incidents but not all incidents are security breaches.
3. Malicious software: Software (e.g. computer viruses, worms, Trojan horses, ransomware, spyware, adware, and scareware) that appears to perform a useful or desirable function but gains unauthorized access to system resources or tricks a user into executing other malicious logic. (SANS).
4. Network Resource: Routers, switches, firewalls, and printers leased or owned by HHS.
5. Personal networking device: Any personally-owned device that provides network connectivity through wired or wireless interfaces (e.g., hub, switch, router, firewall, wireless access point, hotspot).
6. Security Breach:
    a. Breach (as it related to protected health information (PHI)): The unauthorized acquisition, access, use, or disclosure or privacy of such information, except where an unauthorized person to whom such information is disclosed would not reasonably have been able to retain such information.
    b. Breach (as it relates to personally identifiable information (PII)): The loss of control, compromise, unauthorized disclosure, acquisition, access, or any similar term referring to situations where persons other than authorized users and for authorized purposes have access or potential access to PII, whether physical or electronic.
7. Users: All state employees, contractors, interns, volunteers, and approved federal reviewers who use HHS computing, information, and networking resources.

Policy

1. General Use and Ownership

a. HHS-issued equipment shall only be used for work-related activities.
b. All data and information users create on HHS information systems remains the property of HHS.
c. Users shall report the theft, loss, or unauthorized disclosure of HHS information to their supervisor and the Data Sharing, Privacy and Open Records Bureau in the Compliance division within 24 hours of discovering the incident.
d. Users shall exercise due diligence and care in the use and maintenance of the equipment, software, and/or services.
e. Users may access, use, or share HHS information only to the extent it is authorized by law, in compliance with Iowa HHS confidentiality and data sharing policies, and necessary to fulfill their job duties. Refer questions about data sharing to the Data Sharing, Privacy and Open Records Bureau in the Compliance division.

f. Iowa HHS reserves the right to audit its networks and systems on a periodic basis to ensure compliance with this policy.

2. Network Activities: Users shall

a. Complete all assigned annual or regular privacy and security training within the assigned time frames.
b. Only access data required to perform their job duties.
c. Use caution when opening email attachments received from unknown senders as they may contain malicious software.
d. Contact the HHS Help Desk immediately if they believe their machine has been infected or compromised.

3. Prohibited Practices

a. Under no circumstances is a user authorized to engage in any activity that is illegal under state or federal law while utilizing Iowa HHS-owned computing, information, and network resources.

b. System Activities: **Users shall not**

i. Save HHS information on a non-HHS computer or mobile device.
ii. Use a non-HHS computer or mobile device to conduct HHS business unless an exception from the Department of Management is granted.
iii. Use HHS computing, information, and network resources for personal gain.
iv. Violate the rights of any person or company protected by copyright, trade secret, patent, intellectual property, or similar laws or regulations.
v. Install or distribute software products not appropriately licensed or approved for use by HHS.
vi. Use HHS-owned computing, information, and network resources to actively engage in procuring or transmitting material that is in violation of civil rights or workplace violence laws, such as transmitting emails with sexist or racist content, or accessing pornographic material.
vii. Make fraudulent offers of products, items, or services, originating from any HHS account.
viii. Access personal accounts, including personal email accounts, from HHS-owned devices.
ix. Allow family members or other non-HHS staff access to HHS-owned equipment.

c. Network Activities: **Users shall not**

i. Create or forward, "junk mail", “multi-level marketing”, “chain letters” or other unsolicited advertising material.
ii. Commit any form of harassment via email or telephone, whether through language, frequency, or size of messages.
iii. Forge or use email header information in an unauthorized manner.
iv. Use HHS-owned computing, information, or network resources to advertise any goods or services not approved by HHS, whether through an HHS email account, or any personal email account that

could be accessed via a separate Internet/Intranet/Extranet service provider.

v. Knowingly introduce malicious software such as computer viruses, worms, Trojan horses, ransomware, spyware, adware, and scareware, into HHS-owned computing, information, or network resources.

vi. Intentionally cause disruptions of network communication, including, but not limited to denial of service and/or forged routing information for malicious purposes.

d. Blogging and Social Media Sites

i. Users shall not blog, create, or post social media content during work hours for any reason unless as explicitly authorized for the fulfillment of work requirements.

ii. Users shall not access social media sites or use social media services on HHS- owned computing, information, or network resources unless they are explicitly authorized for the fulfillment of their work requirements. For further information reference the HHS Social Media Policy and Procedures.

e. Personally Owned Devices

i. Users shall not connect non-Iowa HHS-owned computers, mobile devices, personal storage, or personal networking devices to Iowa HHS-owned computing, information, and network resources.

f. Web-Based Storage and E-Mail

i. Users shall not access personal cloud-based storage (e.g., DropBox, Google Drive, Mega, iCloud, Box, SpiderOak) or webmail services (e.g., GMail, GMX, iCloud, Yahoo Mail and Zoho) from an Iowa HHS-owned computing or mobile device. The exception to this is cloud services for business purposes approved and authorized for use by the Department of Management-Division of Technology which includes OneDrive.

g. Confidential Information: **User shall not**

i. Save Iowa HHS confidential information on their Iowa HHS-owned computing or mobile device OR a non-Iowa HHS-owned computer or mobile device.

ii. Save any Iowa HHS confidential information to cloud-based storage services (e.g., DropBox, Mega, iCloud, Box, SpiderOak). The exception to this is cloud storage for business purposes approved and authorized for use by the Department of Management-Division of Technology which includes OneDrive.

iii. Store confidential data on removable storage media (e.g., floppy disks, compact/digital video disks, flash/thumb drives, external hard disk drives, and flash memory cards/drives that contain non-volatile memory) unless the device is encrypted in accordance with the State Enterprise Standard, S-012-005, Removable Storage Encryption.

4. Telework Site

a. Printing
   i. Users can print non-confidential information on a personal or Iowa HHS-owned printer.
   ii. Users shall not print confidential information of any kind on a personal printer. Printing of confidential information must be done at an Iowa HHS office location or on an Iowa HHS-owned printer at the designated telework location and secured. The exception is federal tax information which cannot be printed on any personal or Iowa HHS-owned device under any circumstance.

b. Safeguarding Confidential information
   i. Users shall secure confidential information in a locked desk, cabinet, or safe when not in use. If this is not feasible, users shall not take confidential paper documents to a telework location.
   ii. Users can shred confidential paper documents at a telework location if their shredder meets the P-4 security level (≤ 160 mm² particles with width ≤6 mm). If not, confidential paper documents must be returned to the Iowa HHS office for shredding.
   iii. Users shall track the removal and return of all confidential paper documents.

5. *Cell Phones Usage*

a. Personal phones can be used to make phone calls to conduct Iowa HHS business which does not involve contacting Iowa HHS clients. Any personal device used may be subject to discovery in a criminal matter or be made available for an audit or investigation.

b. Iowa HHS-issued cell phones shall be used to conduct Iowa HHS business that involves contacting Iowa HHS clients. Staff shall not change mobile device configurations of state or county owned mobile devices set by the HHS Help Desk.

c. In consultation with their supervisor, users can use FaceTime and Google Duo to communicate with clients using Iowa HHS-issued cell phones only.

d. When talking to clients on the phone, users shall take all necessary precautions to ensure the confidentiality of client information.

e. Staff shall not send text messages with confidential information in them. If a text message with confidential information is received, place the necessary information in the Iowa HHS system of record and delete the text message immediately. If no other means of communication is practical, consult the Data Sharing, Privacy and Open Records Bureau to discuss an exception.

f. Staff shall not download applications to state or county-owned cell phones without prior approval of the Department of Management-Division of Information Technology.

6. Video Conferencing Initiated by Iowa HHS

a. Should in-person communication with clients not be feasible, in consultation with the supervisor, users can initiate a video conference. However, the only approved video conferencing tools are Microsoft Teams and Zoom as installed on Iowa HHS devices.
b. Internal discussions involving confidential information can be held using Microsoft Teams as installed on Iowa HHS devices.
c. Users can record video conferencing sessions.
d. For consideration of alternatives for non-confidential information, users shall follow existing software purchasing approval procedures outlined in the IT Purchasing and Contracts and RFP Review Policy v3.0.

7. Video Conferencing Software used by Other Entities

a. The court or other Iowa HHS contractors may initiate video conferences using software such as GoToMeeting, Cisco WebEx, etc.
b. Users can participate in video conferences initiated by other entities.
c. Contractors who are business associates of Iowa HHS are required to comply with HIPAA.
d. When selecting a videoconferencing solution, contractors should consider relevant compliance issues and consult with their own legal counsel.

8. Authentication

a. All HHS user passwords shall be in compliance with the State of Iowa security policy and any special federal security requirements that apply to the user's role at HHS.
b. Users shall not reveal their account password to others, including their supervisor, individuals in their leadership chain, or the Helpdesk.
c. Users shall not keep a written list of passwords with an Iowa HHS-owned device.

9. Security Practices

a. Acceptable use of Iowa HHS-owned computing, information, and network resources entails appropriate and reasonable security practices to prevent unauthorized access. The mechanisms to minimize the opportunity for unauthorized users to assume the identity and/or privileges of the intended user during a user's absence include the following:
    i. All staff shall only access information resources remotely through encrypted Virtual Private Network (VPN).
    ii. Authorized third parties (customers, contractors, vendors, etc.) may be approved for VPN access to HHS networks.
    iii. Remote users accessing HHS networks are responsible for selecting an Internet Service Provider (ISP), coordinating the installation of the internet service, installing any required software, and paying associated fees for their personal ISP.

iv. No personal computers, laptops, tablets, etc. or computers found at third-party locations such as hotels or libraries can be used for remote access to HHS information systems.
v. All Iowa HHS-owned computing or mobile devices shall be secured by logging off or locking them when left unattended (e.g., stepping away and the device is out of sight, leaving the work area even momentarily, or walking to the printer to retrieve a print job).
vi. Users shall make every effort to position screens of Iowa HHS-owned computing and mobile devices so they cannot easily be seen by anyone other than the user (or other authorized Iowa HHS users).
vii. User shall ensure Iowa HHS equipment shall only be used by the user assigned to the equipment at a telework location.
viii. Users shall take appropriate actions to assure the physical security of Iowa HHS-owned computing and mobile devices.
ix. Users shall not check Iowa HHS-owned computing or mobile devices in airline luggage systems (shall be treated as a piece of carry-on equipment), with hotel porters, or any other individual. They are to remain in the possession of the user or be secured in either a hotel room or locked safe.

10. Lost or Stolen Devices

a. A lost, missing, or stolen Iowa HHS-owned computing or mobile devices is considered a security incident. The Data Sharing, Privacy, and Open Records Bureau shall report lost, missing, or stolen computing or mobile devices to the State of Iowa Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) within 24 hours of discovery.

11. Bluetooth Devices

a. Users shall contact the HHS Help Desk for the list of Bluetooth devices which may be connected to state and county owned mobile devices purchased at state expense.

Management Commitment

This policy has been approved by the HHS Chief of Compliance. Iowa HHS supervisors are responsible for ensuring staff are aware of and understand this policy and procedure.

Compliance with This Policy

1. Compliance measurement: The Compliance Division may verify compliance with this policy through various methods, including but not limited to, internal audits and information received by the Compliance Division, HHS Division Director or Human Resources.
2. Exceptions: Any exception to the policy shall be approved by the Compliance Division Director in advance.

3. 3Noncompliance: Violations of this policy are grounds for disciplinary action, up to and including termination.
4. Iowa HHS staff may be held civilly or criminally liable for improper use or disclosure of confidential Information.

References

Not applicable.

Review and Change Log

DATE	ACTION	SUMMARY OF CHANGES	REVIEWERS
09/12/2024	Approved	Revised HHS Policy v2.0	Deputy Director/Chief of Compliance
4/20/2022	Approved	Revised HHS Policy v1.1	Deputy Director
02/18/2019	Approved	New HHS Policy v1.0	Director

Signature

This policy and procedure have been reviewed and approved by Sarah Reisetter, HHS Deputy Director and Chief of Compliance.

Sarah Reisetter Digitally signed by Sarah Reisetter
Date: 2024.09.12 07:59:14 -05'00'

HHS Deputy Director/Chief of Compliance Date